Amazon Chime

FrontRunner

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THE CHEATSHEET

Team Goal

Gain leadership buy-in to support frontline worker productivity—

Most productivity apps focus on knowledge workers. We had the opportunity to create a new product that's one easy place to manage your day, week, month.

My role

Lead product & design team collaboration from inception to PRFAQ prototype

Designed for...

Frontline workers and supervisors coordinating the daily complexities of a physically-run business.

Project Complexity

PMs and designers were both overwhelmed by the ambitious, open-ended initiative. It was an opportunity to figure it out together.

- **What exactly are we building?**
  Businesses have a lot of logistics—calendars, payroll, tasks, training, inventory, communication, etc
- **Who all are we building it for?**
  “Frontline” is broad—restaurants, retail, warehouse, healthcare, etc , as well as all the roles that work to support them
- **What differentiates it from the market?**
  MS Teams and a couple other products were already trying to serve frontline businesses in a similar way
- **How will we fund it?**
  Products are better adopted when free, but they don’t pay for themselves—paths to discovery, purchase, license models

(Product + design) process

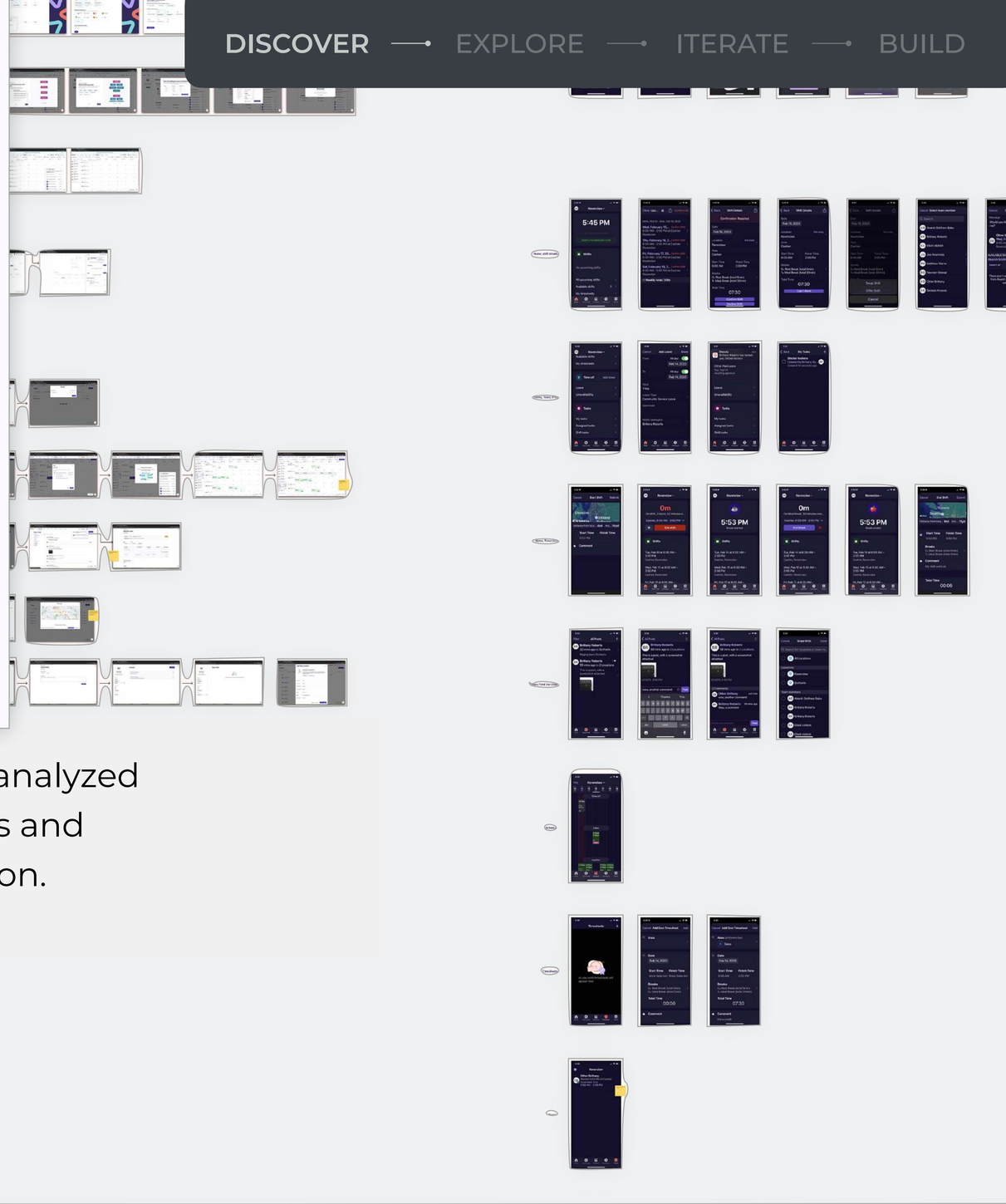
- **Discover** - Interviews & competitor research
- **Explore** - Brainstorming, user flows, storyboarding
- **Create & iterate** - Wireframes & usability
- **Build** - PRFAQ Prototype

The Team:

Designers - Navreen, Senada, & Brittany

PMs - Joe, Matthew, Akarsh

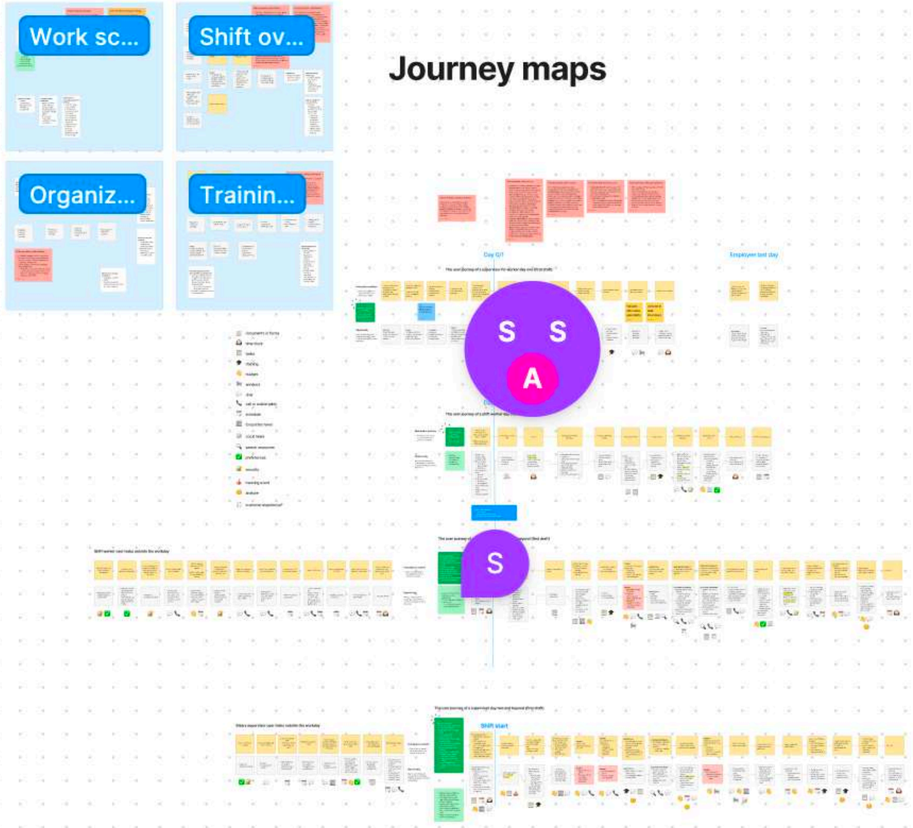
Researcher - Mikey



Competitor research for market differentiation

Between observing interviews of frontline workers, Brittany & I analyzed competitor products mentioned by interviewees (e.g. MS Teams and Deputy). This was foundational to the PMs' case for differentiation.

- Catalogue key features and user stories
- Analyze ease of use and functionality
- Note competitive differentiation we can offer



Distill research & interview data

In tandem with competitor research, the team also did a deep dive into the UX interviews to build empathy with our audience. In Figma, we worked through journey maps and storyboards as a team.

- Defining user personas and needs
- Map potential journeys and pain points, informed by research

Project complexity - “Who” and “what” defined

Across business use cases, we honed our focus for a successful app experience by understanding common pain points. We identified what we needed to solve for competitive edge:

MUST HAVE:

- **Communication for changing shifts, teams, locations**
  Often have to use personal means to communicate for work, need something central but separate from texting/social media
- **Shift scheduling & management**
  Still manual for many businesses, need something easy to use (especially tricky with rotating staff)
- **Task assignment & management**
  To-do lists are important but frequently neglected, need something collaborative and reusable

GOOD TO HAVE:

- **Trackable training/reference materials**
  Documents relevant to the job often hard to find, need something easy to reference and find

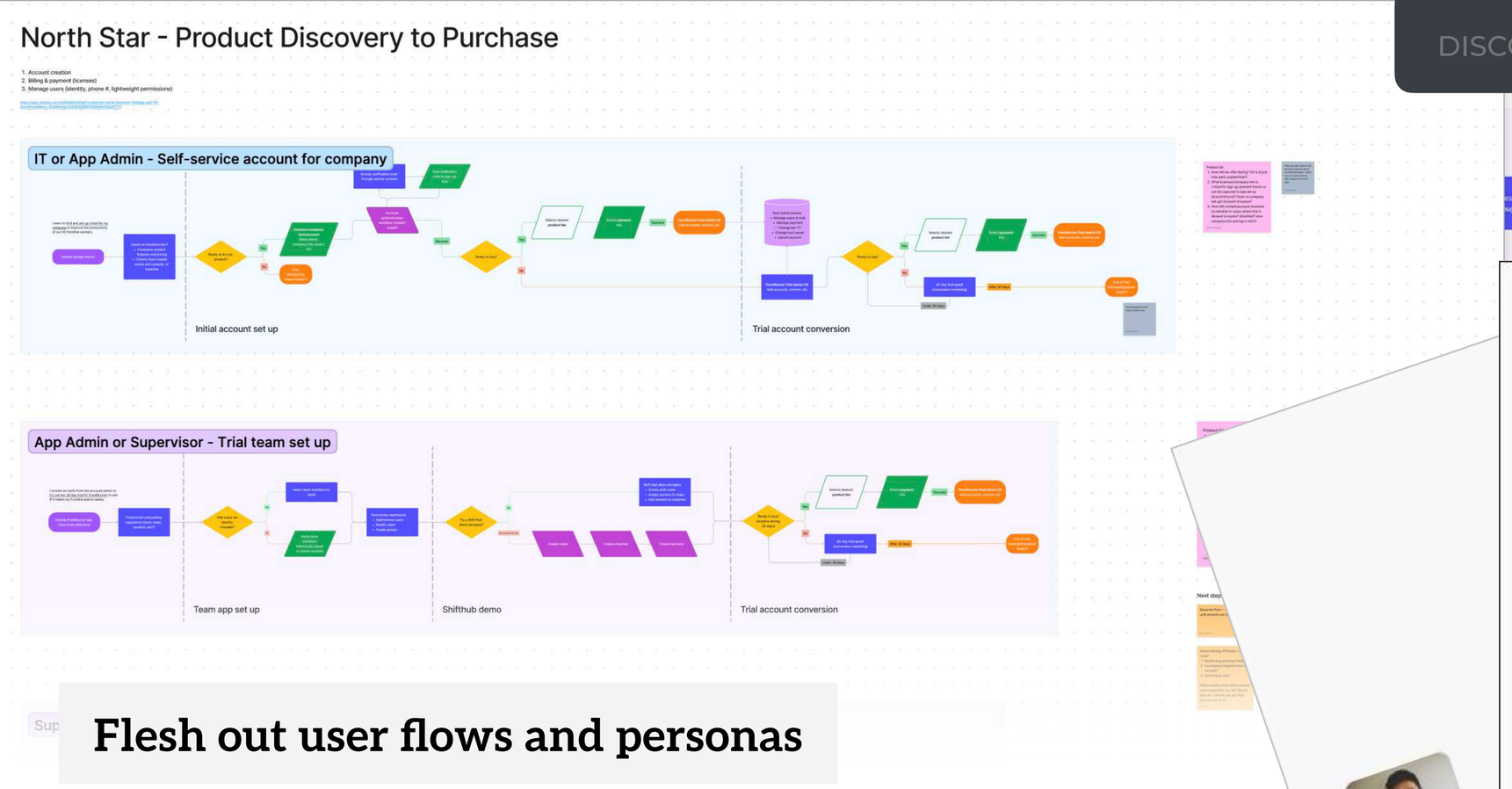
App experience:

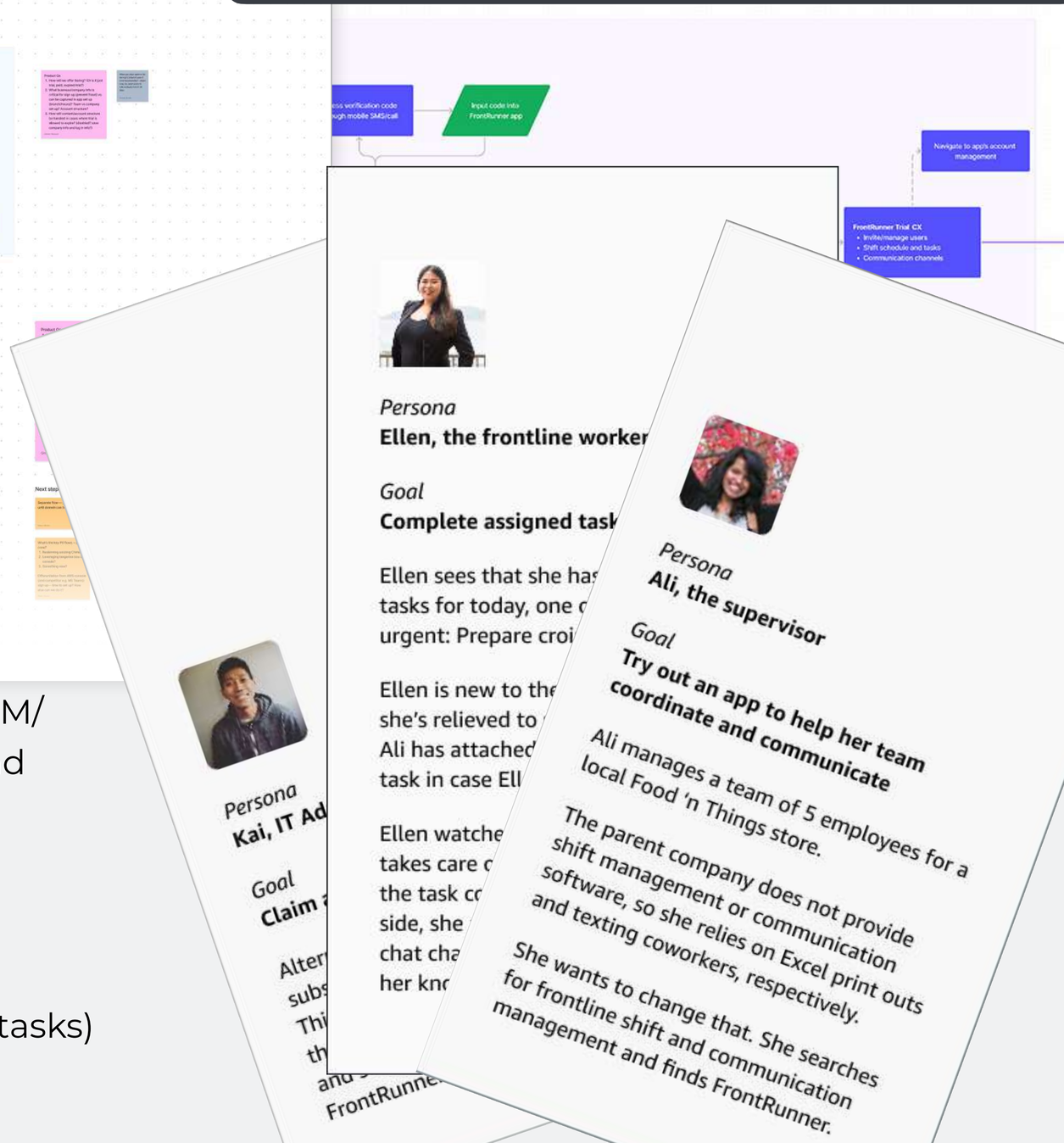
Frontline worker

Supervisor

Purchasing power:

Admin/business owner



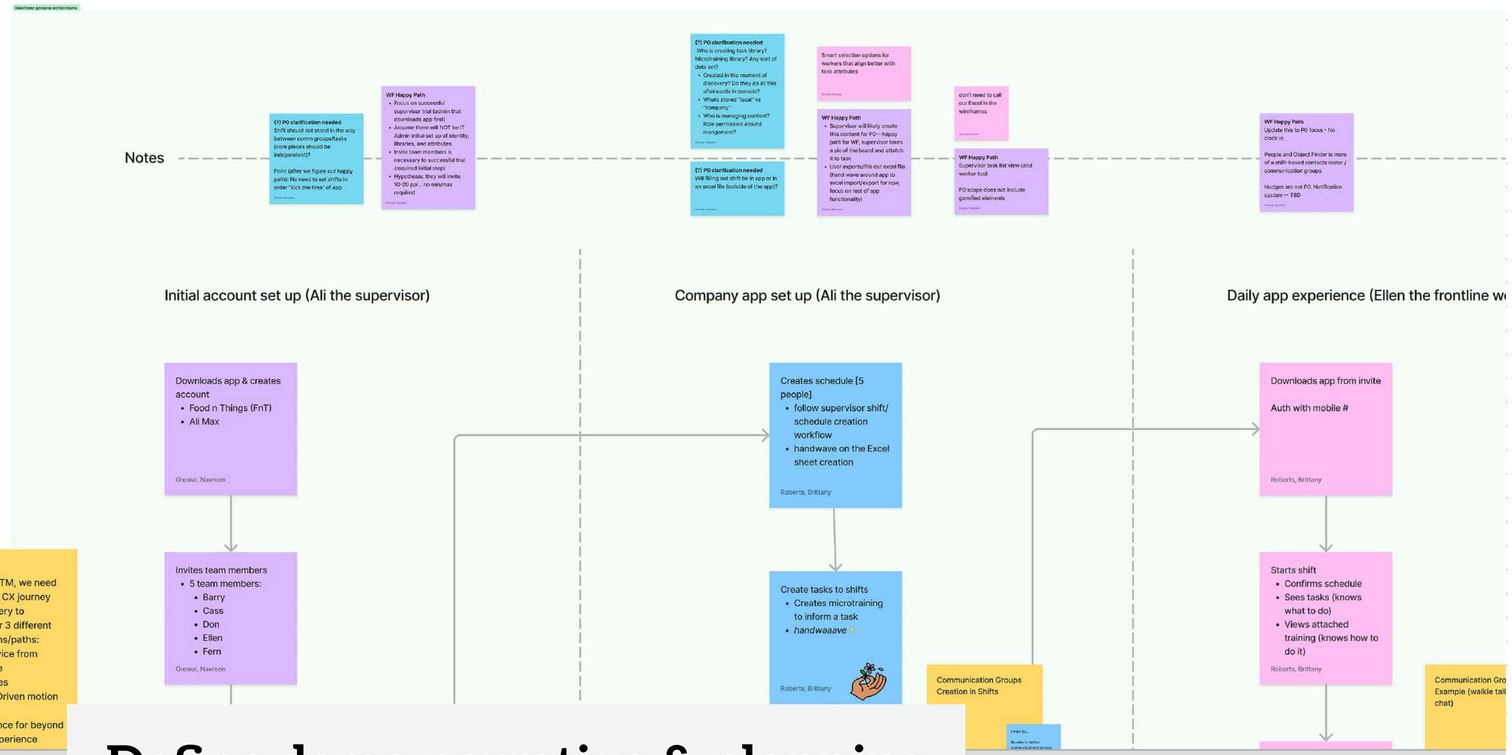


Flesh out user flows and personas

Armed with priorities from journey mapping, we broke into PM/designer pairs per persona to define high-level experience and requirements. This is where the rubber met the road.

- Solidify personas and user goals
- Map out important use case flows and north star
- Work through complex, webbed interactions (scheduling, tasks)

Story Planning



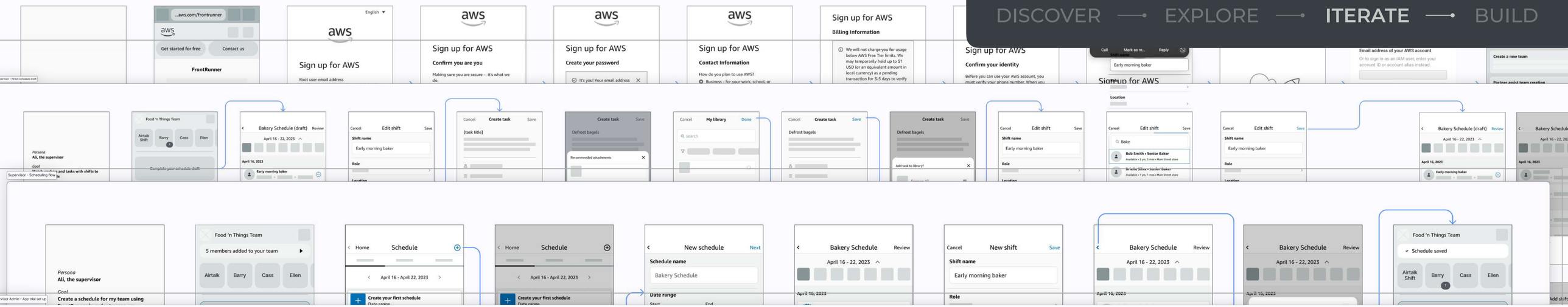
Define demo narrative & planning

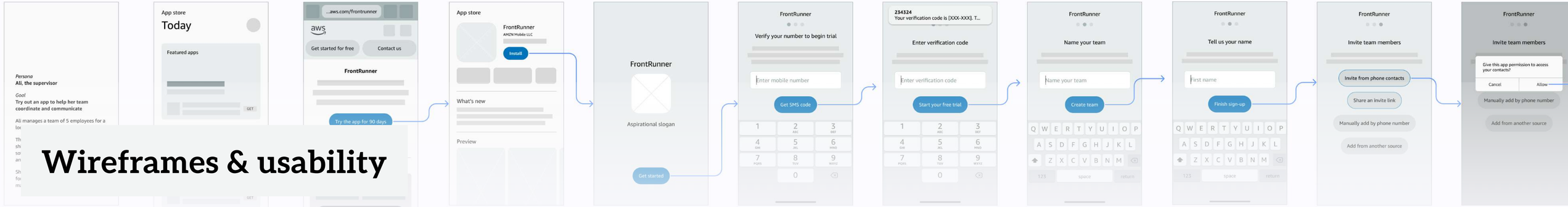
A major challenge for the team was getting bogged down in details. I worked with the designers to build a crisp story for the demo. It helped us focus on championing FrontRunner's product pitch.

- Narrative tying 3 personas into cohesive purchase story
- Scope out remaining design effort and timing to delivery

DISCOVER → **EXPLORE** → ITERATE → BUILD

Work				
Admin - Sign up & conversion	**Wireframe round 1** Rough set up of important screens	~20 screens	1-1.5 weeks	
Supervisor - Schedules and tasks	**Wireframe round 1** Rough set up of important screens	~20 screens	1-1.5 weeks	
				4/21 wireframe v1 admin + supervisor review (static)
Admin - Sign up & conversion	**Wireframe round 2** Iteration of rough content/flows	Break out conversion flow: • In-app purchase • Out of app purchase (aws)	.5 week	
Supervisor - Schedules and tasks	**Wireframe round 2** Iteration of rough content/flows	Break out schedule flow into own user tasks: • Schedule creation • Task creation • Schedule population	.5 week	
				4/26 wireframe v2 admin + supervisor review (static)
Supervisor - Dashboard	**Wireframe round 1** Rough set up of important screens	Different states and feedback updates	.5-1 week	
Worker - Sign up & dashboard	**Wireframe round 1** Rough set up of important screens	~8 screens	1-1.5 weeks	
Admin - Sign up & conversion	**Wireframe round 3** Finalize content/flows	Add partner screens and minor rearranging and dashboard expansion	.5 week	
Supervisor - Schedules and tasks	**Wireframe round 3** Finalize content/flows	Minor rearranging and dashboard expansion	.5 week	
				5/5 wireframes for Alex (static)
Clickable prototype for completed admin/supervisor	Wireframe fidelity linked into clickable presentation	Ongoing development following behind finished screens	2 weeks in parallel	**Rough Admin + Supervisors by 5/4** Ongoing refinement
Worker - Schedule & tasks	**Wireframe round 1** Rough set up of important screens	Worker - ~20 screens	1 weeks	
Supervisor - Dashboard	**Wireframe round 2** Iteration of rough content/flows	TBD feedback	1-1.5 weeks	
Worker - Dashboard	**Wireframe round 2** Iteration of rough content/flows	TBD feedback	1-1.5 weeks	
				~ est 5/19 wireframe v1 worker complete (based on user flows)
Worker - Schedule & tasks	**Wireframe round 2** Iteration of rough content/flows	TBD feedback	.5 week	Potential 6/6 check in
Supervisor and worker - Dashboard	**Wireframe round 3** Finalize content/flows	TBD feedback	.5-1 week	
Worker - Schedule & tasks	**Wireframe round 3** Finalize content/flows	TBD feedback	.5-1 week	





Wireframes & usability

The work up front created an efficient path to build wireframes. We moved quickly mapping out important interactions. Mikey used them to validate our direction with frontline workers.

- Map story user flows to wireframe flows
- Pivot to include LLM integration
- Iterate towards final UI with team feedback and usability

SHOWTIME!

FrontRunner PRFAQ Demo

Supervisor Ali starts 90 day trial

- She creates an account for her team and invites them
- She builds her first schedule with tasks

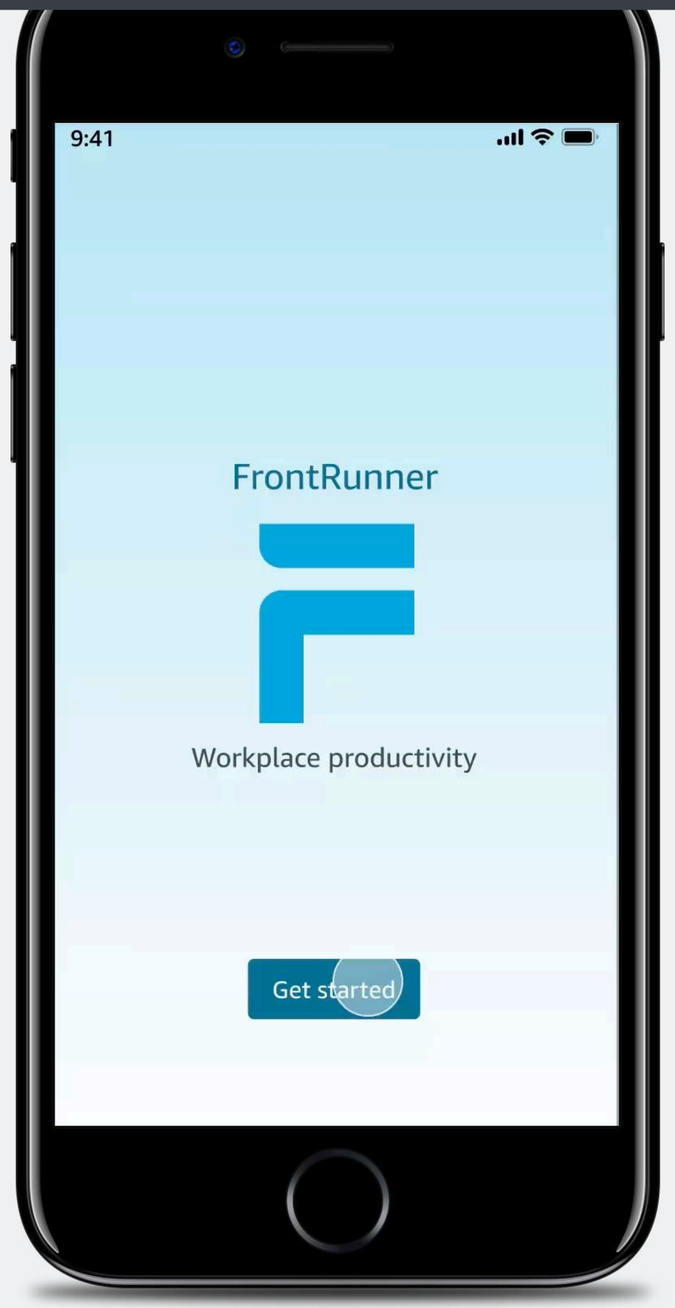
Worker Ellen joins trial

- She reviews her shift schedule
- She completes a high priority task with the help of an LLM assistant

Supervisor Ali purchases license

- She uses the purchase flow to buy the product for her team's business use

P0 Prototype (video)



Project Retrospective

Leadership gave the project a greenlight for 2023 funding, believing we provided sufficient evidence for differentiation and monetization options.

We were proud of the work we had done as a team:

- **What we liked**
  - Partnering design and PMs from the beginning
  - Front-loading strategy work, speeding up tactical
  - Start to finish feedback from frontline workers
- **What we would do differently**
  - Get to user flows sooner
  - Find a cyclic movement from flows to wireframes
  - Include an engineering lead for transparency